Energy words · Glossary

Grade 6 · IB MYP 1 · Unit 2 Thinking about Energy · 36 words in simple English

Name: _____ Class: _____ My first language: _____

👀 Read the word and look at the picture. ✍️ Write the word in your language. 🗣️ Say the example sentence out loud. 🙈 Cover the meaning and test yourself.

1 · Energy and its stores | 2 · Energy transfers | 3 · Electricity | 4 · Heat and matter | 5 · Energy resources

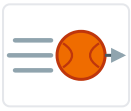
⚡ 1 · Energy and its stores



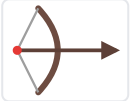
1 energy *noun*
What makes things happen. It makes things move, heat up, light up or make a sound.
e.g. We need energy to run and play.
In my language: _____



2 joule (J) *noun · joules*
The unit we use to measure energy. Its symbol is J.
e.g. The lamp uses 10 J of energy every second.
In my language: _____



3 kinetic energy *noun*
The energy that something has because it is moving.
e.g. A running dog has kinetic energy.
In my language: _____



4 potential energy *noun*
Stored energy. It is waiting to be used.
e.g. A pulled bow has potential energy.
In my language: _____



5 thermal energy *noun*
The energy of the moving particles inside a substance. The faster they move, the hotter it is.
e.g. Hot tea has a lot of thermal energy.
In my language: _____



6 light energy *noun*
Energy that we can see. It travels as waves, like light from the Sun.
e.g. A lamp gives out light energy.
In my language: _____



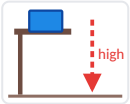
7 sound energy *noun*
Energy carried by vibrations (very fast shaking) through air, water or solids. We hear it.
e.g. A drum gives out sound energy.
In my language: _____



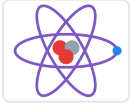
8 elastic energy *noun*
Energy stored in something that is stretched or squashed, like a spring.
e.g. A squashed spring stores elastic energy.
In my language: _____



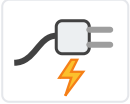
9 chemical energy *noun*
Energy stored in food, fuels and batteries. It is released when they react or burn.
e.g. Food gives our body chemical energy.
In my language: _____



10 gravitational energy *noun*
Energy stored in something because it is high up. The higher it is, the more it stores.
e.g. A book on a high shelf has gravitational energy.
In my language: _____

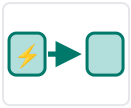


11 nuclear energy *noun*
Energy stored in the centre (nucleus) of an atom.
e.g. The Sun shines because of nuclear energy.
In my language: _____



12 electrical energy *noun*
Energy carried by moving charges in a circuit. It makes our devices work.
e.g. A phone charger transfers electrical energy.
In my language: _____

2 · Energy transfers



13 energy transfer *noun · transfers*
When energy moves from one object or store to another.
e.g. When you kick a ball, energy is transferred to the ball.
In my language: _____

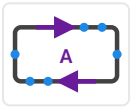


14 efficient *adjective*
Uses energy well: most of the energy is useful and only a little is wasted.
e.g. An LED bulb is more efficient than an old bulb.
In my language: _____



15 inefficient *adjective*
Wastes a lot of energy, often as heat or sound.
e.g. An old car is inefficient: it gets very hot.
In my language: _____

3 · Electricity



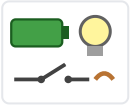
16 current *noun · currents*
The flow of charge around a circuit. We measure it in amps (A).
e.g. The current makes the bulb light up.
In my language: _____



17 charge *noun · charges*
Tiny particles, like electrons, carry charge. Charges push or pull on each other.
e.g. Electrons have a negative charge.
In my language: _____



18 circuit *noun · circuits*
A complete loop that electricity can flow around. If there is a gap, it stops.
e.g. The bulb lights when the circuit is complete.
In my language: _____

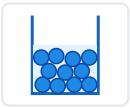


19 component *noun · components*
One part of a circuit, like a cell, a bulb, a switch or a wire.
e.g. A switch is a component.
In my language: _____

4 · Heat and matter



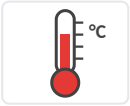
20 solid *noun · solids*
A state of matter with a fixed shape and a fixed volume.
e.g. Ice is a solid.
In my language: _____



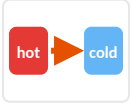
21 liquid *noun · liquids*
A state of matter with a fixed volume but no fixed shape. It can flow.
e.g. Water is a liquid.
In my language: _____



22 gas *noun · gases*
A state of matter with no fixed shape or volume. It spreads out to fill a space.
e.g. Steam is a gas.
In my language: _____



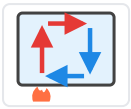
23 temperature *noun*
How hot or cold something is. We measure it in degrees Celsius (°C).
e.g. The temperature today is 25 °C.
In my language: _____



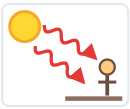
24 heat *noun*
Thermal energy moving from a hotter object to a colder one.
e.g. Heat moves from a hot cup into your cold hands.
In my language: _____



25 conduction *noun*
Heat moving through a material from particle to particle. It happens best in solids.
e.g. A metal spoon in hot soup gets hot by conduction.
In my language: _____



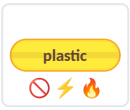
26 convection *noun*
Heat moving through a liquid or gas: the warm part rises and the cool part sinks.
e.g. Convection warms all the air in a room.
In my language: _____



27 radiation *noun*
Heat moving as invisible waves. It needs no particles, so it can cross empty space.
e.g. We feel the heat of the Sun by radiation.
In my language: _____



28 conductor *noun · conductors*
A material that lets heat or electricity pass through it easily, like metal.
e.g. Copper is a good conductor.
In my language: _____



29 insulator *noun · insulators*
A material that does not let heat or electricity pass through it easily, like plastic.
e.g. The plastic around a wire is an insulator.
In my language: _____



30 insulation *noun*
A material that we use to slow down heat moving in or out.
e.g. Insulation in the roof keeps the house warm.
In my language: _____

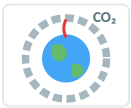
🌍 5 · Energy resources



31 fuel *noun · fuels*
A substance that stores chemical energy. We burn it to release the energy.
e.g. Wood and petrol are fuels.
In my language: _____



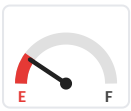
32 fossil fuel *noun · fossil fuels*
A fuel made over millions of years from the remains of ancient plants and animals.
e.g. Coal, oil and natural gas are fossil fuels.
In my language: _____



33 greenhouse gas *noun · greenhouse gases*
A gas in the air that traps heat around the Earth, like carbon dioxide (CO_2).
e.g. Burning fossil fuels makes greenhouse gases.
In my language: _____



34 renewable *adjective*
An energy resource that will not run out, like the Sun, the wind or moving water.
e.g. Wind power is renewable.
In my language: _____



35 non-renewable *adjective*
An energy resource that will run out one day, because it cannot be replaced quickly.
e.g. Oil is non-renewable.
In my language: _____



36 sustainability *noun*
Using resources carefully, so that people in the future will have enough too.
e.g. Switching off lights helps sustainability.
In my language: _____

A–Z · find a word

charge	17 · p. 2	energy transfer	13 · p. 2	light energy	6 · p. 1
chemical energy	9 · p. 1	fossil fuel	32 · p. 3	liquid	21 · p. 2
circuit	18 · p. 2	fuel	31 · p. 3	non-renewable	35 · p. 3
component	19 · p. 2	gas	22 · p. 2	nuclear energy	11 · p. 1
conduction	25 · p. 2	gravitational energy	10 · p. 1	potential energy	4 · p. 1
conductor	28 · p. 3	greenhouse gas	33 · p. 3	radiation	27 · p. 3
convection	26 · p. 3	heat	24 · p. 2	renewable	34 · p. 3
current	16 · p. 2	inefficient	15 · p. 2	solid	20 · p. 2
efficient	14 · p. 2	insulation	30 · p. 3	sound energy	7 · p. 1
elastic energy	8 · p. 1	insulator	29 · p. 3	sustainability	36 · p. 3
electrical energy	12 · p. 1	joule (J)	2 · p. 1	temperature	23 · p. 2
energy	1 · p. 1	kinetic energy	3 · p. 1	thermal energy	5 · p. 1

Opposites

efficient ↔ **inefficient**

renewable ↔ **non-renewable**

conductor ↔ **insulator**

kinetic energy ↔ **potential energy**

💡 Make your own word cards: write the English word on the front, and the picture and the word in your language on the back. Practise with a partner.